

Conclusion: The Power of Team

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So, to wrap it up, we've talked about how responsibility, loyalty, and communication are the foundation of successful teams. Take a moment to think about where your team is and how you can start to implement some of these principles. Being a part of an amazing team is something you'll never forget. It doesn't come naturally, but it can be taught.

When people understand their roles and trust their teammates to do their job, like I've witnessed on multiple SEC championships for the Lady Vols, it was amazing. We had:

Shooters who shot, people who grabbed rebounds, ladies to make defensive plays.

Everyone knew their role. It helped us win games. In her book, *Reach for the Summit*, Pat said, "You don't just lump a group of people together in a room and call them a team and expect them to behave like one. No organization will succeed without teamwork, no matter how many all-stars you have."

"I talk about teamwork until I have no voice left. Without an incentive, people simply won't work together consistently. But if you grasp the real incentive behind teamwork, it suddenly becomes a whole lot easier. Teamwork is really just a form of trust. It's what happens when you surrender the mistaken idea that you can go at it alone and realize that you won't achieve your personal goals without the support of your colleagues. Once you buy into it, you'll feel a sense of relief. It's like relaxing into a chair after a long day on your feet."

At the end of the day, you play a major part in creating a team that no one will want to leave, a team that makes going into work a joy, a team that makes reaching difficult obstacles easy, maybe even fun. I was the person in the office when the players needed a snack or they needed a laugh, they knew where to go. Me. It seemed small, but that outlet played a big part in their well-being off the court.

I knew my strengths and I felt empowered by the coaches, players, and staff to bring my authentic self to the office every day because that's what the team needed. So you go out there and make these principles your own. You have the tools to make your career and your organization great. We're right behind you all the way and we're cheering you on.